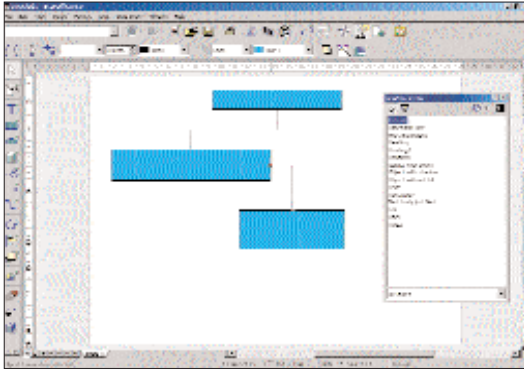




Use connectors to make flowcharts easily

options to let you filter data and view data for certain fields, which is handy with large spreadsheets containing lots of data. The Autofilter option works just fine with the entire spreadsheet or with selected rows or columns. The standard filter lets you set up to three conditions for filtering while the advanced filter lets you set up to eight filters.

As in Excel, you can represent the cell data in the form of charts. Selecting Insert > Chart brings up the Autoformat Chart dialog, which helps you choose between bar charts, pie charts or radar charts. There aren't as many chart options as

in Excel, which has several formats with 3D effects.

Insert > Function List gives you a list of the functions in Calc. To insert functions, use the Function Autopilot on the toolbar menu. You can also use the Autopilot to create your own formulae.

Insert > Object > Formula activates Star Math. Once activated, you can use the toolbars in Star Math to add mathematical formulae to your spreadsheets.

So what's it going to be?

The free beta version of StarOffice 6.0 that we've looked at here is feature rich and packs in a lot of functionality, in spite of the fact that it doesn't include applications such as Star Mail and Scheduler, which you will find in the paid CD version of even StarOffice 5.2. Additionally, stability isn't one of the strong points of the StarOffice 6.0 beta version, hence you have to keep saving your work periodically. Documentation for StarOffice, in general, isn't too good and the Help files aren't easy to follow.

We suggest you wait for the release of the full version of StarOffice 6.0 before you decide to completely switch over. But till then, have fun fiddling with this version of StarOffice—try it, tweak it and use it. 

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1/2 page H AD